

North Port Meals on Wheels – Grant Utilization Narrative for 2024

Thanks to the incredible support we've received through grants, contract awards, private donations, and food contributions from Publix, 2024 has been a remarkable year for North Port Meals on Wheels. Your generosity has allowed us to grow rapidly, meeting the needs of all our clients without implementing a waiting list.

November 1 marks the first anniversary of expanding our service area to include Wellen Park. We've already served about 20 clients in this new region, reflecting our commitment to reaching more people in need. Additionally, we welcomed our first full-time Executive Director, Sharon Wallace, in mid-September -- just in time to navigate two hurricanes. Sharon has been an incredible leader, guiding our team with resilience and dedication as we adapt to our organization's ongoing growth and challenges.

A significant portion of our mission is ensuring that everyone has access to nutritious meals, regardless of financial barriers. Over the past few years, 45-50% of the meals we deliver have been provided at no cost or a reduced price (typically \$2.50 or less) to clients meeting specific Federal Poverty Guidelines. In 2024, the need for subsidized meals has increased, and we project that approximately 53% of all meals delivered this year will be subsidized. For the first time in our history, we expect to deliver over 40,000 meals—a milestone made possible by your support.

The attached spreadsheet details how our grant and contract funds were allocated to cover the cost of meals for clients paying less than the standard amount. It includes actual figures through October 2024, with projections for November and December. The document breaks down:

- The percentage of meals subsidized
- The total expenses associated with subsidized meals
- Payments received from clients paying partial amounts
- The remaining "Fundraising Need for free/reduced meals."

Starting on row 23, you'll find a breakdown of grants received in 2024, listed by award date. We allocated the United Way grant last, as its unrestricted nature allowed us to use it flexibly throughout the year.

Your support has been instrumental in helping us achieve these milestones. On behalf of our board and our clients, thank you for your generosity and partnership. We couldn't have accomplished this success without you.

With gratitude,
Scott Hedrick
Board Chair, North Port Meals on Wheels